

RATIONALISM

RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND → CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO → CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND → DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION → SPINOZA'S SUBSTANCE-ATTRIBUTE-MODE HIERARCHY AND → SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE

Read the thick cyan rail from Stage 00 to the final core synthesis. Each card uses a concept-appropriate structure; the grey E card is optional enrichment only and never repairs missing core content.

PRIMARY CORE FLOW SUBORDINATE EXTRA APPROVAL / REVIEW

Approval: FALSE • Pending user review • source generation g3 and all prior artifacts unchanged

CORE BEFORE EXTRA • prior artefacts unchanged • exact same master drives poster and tiles

00

STAGE 00 RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND CONNECTED 3-1-INFINITY SEQUENCE

RATIONALIST STARTING PROBLEM AND CONNECTED 3-1-INFINITY SEQUENCE

CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD?

A PRIORI PRINCIPLES + INTUITION + DEDUCTION

SUBSTANCE, ATTRIBUTE, MODE AND SUFFICIENT EXPLANATION

GOD + MIND + BODY

INTERACTION PROBLEM

ONE GOD/NATURE

PARALLELISM + NECESSITY

CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD?

METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction

METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation

DESCARTES: God + mind + body → interaction problem

SPINOZA: one God/Nature → parallelism + necessity → individuality problem

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- CENTRAL QUESTION: CAN REASON SECURE NECESSARY KNOWLEDGE AND AN INTELLIGIBLE WORLD?
- METHOD: a priori principles + intuition + deduction
- METAPHYSICS: substance, attribute, mode and sufficient explanation

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- DESCARTES: God + mind + body → interaction problem
- SPINOZA: one God/Nature → parallelism + necessity → individuality problem
- LEIBNIZ: many monads → harmony + contingency → economy and evil problem

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- MEMORY: substance 3-1-infinity; mind-body I-P-H.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A shared demand for intelligibility produces different systems because independence, simplicity and individuation are interpreted differently.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Rationalism is unified by confidence in a priori reason but divided by the criterion of substance, which moves from Cartesian dualism through Spinozist monism to Leibnizian monadic pluralism.

01

STAGE 01 CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO AND FIRST CERTAINTY

CARTESIAN METHODIC DOUBT, COGITO AND FIRST CERTAINTY

FOUR METHOD RULES

SIMPLE-TO-COMPLEX ORDER

COMPLETE REVIEW

SENSE ERROR

DREAM ARGUMENT

EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS SUSPEND EVERY BELIEF THAT CAN BE DOUBTED

I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK IMMEDIATE INTUITION

FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence → division → simple-to-complex order → complete review

SENSE ERROR → DREAM ARGUMENT → EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS suspend every belief that can be doubted

COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK immediate intuition, not a syllogism

clear and distinct perception becomes the model

intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

- FOUR METHOD RULES: evidence → division → simple-to-complex order → complete review
- SENSE ERROR → DREAM ARGUMENT → EVIL-GENIUS HYPOTHESIS suspend every belief that can be doubted

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

- COGITO: I AM, I EXIST WHENEVER I THINK immediate intuition, not a syllogism
- clear and distinct perception becomes the model

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

- intuition supplies first principles; deduction orders consequences
- LIMIT: present thinking is certain; enduring res cogitans needs further argument.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — The attempt to doubt thinking existence performs the very thinking whose existence it tries to deny.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The cogito defeats radical doubt performatively: deception may falsify what is thought, but it cannot erase the occurrence and existence of the thinker while thinking.

02

STAGE 02 CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND CIRCLE OBJECTION

CARTESIAN KNOWLEDGE ARCHITECTURE AND CIRCLE OBJECTION

MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA

FACTITIOUS; OBJECTIVE REALITY

REPRESENTATIONAL CONTENT

CAUSAL ADEQUACY OR TRADEMARK ROUTE + ONTOLOGICAL ROUTE; PRESENT

INTELLECT JUDGES EXTENDED, FLEXIBLE, CHANGEABLE IDENTITY BEYOND SENSORY QUALITIES

CLEAR/DISTINCT PREMISES PROVE GOD

GOD GUARANTEES CLEAR/DISTINCT TRUTH

DOCTRINE / CLAIM

- COGITO → IDEAS → GOD → NON-DECEPTION → MATHEMATICS AND EXTERNAL RES EXTENSA
- IDEAS: innate / adventitious / factitious; objective reality = representational content
- GOD: causal adequacy or trademark route + ontological route; present cautiously

OBJECTION / PRESSURE

- WAX: intellect judges extended, flexible, changeable identity beyond sensory qualities
- CIRCLE: clear/distinct premises prove God → God guarantees clear/distinct truth
- REPLY: present intuition compels; God secures memory and extended reasoning

REPLY / RESIDUAL

- RESIDUAL: the divine proofs themselves use inferential premises
- WORLD: involuntary sensory ideas require an active cause; veracity blocks deception
- LIMIT: body-existence is stronger than exact resemblance of sensible qualities.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — A perfect non-deceiving God is used to guarantee that what is clearly and distinctly perceived remains trustworthy beyond immediate attention.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is the epistemic hinge of Cartesian reconstruction because divine non-deception extends clear and distinct certainty beyond the cogito, yet that hinge creates the Cartesian Circle.

03

STAGE 03 DESCARTES ON SUBSTANCE, INTERACTION AND FREEDOM

- WORLD: involuntary sensory ideas require an active cause; veracity blocks deception
- LIMIT: body-existence is stronger than exact resemblance of sensible qualities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: God is the epistemic hinge of Cartesian reconstruction because divine non-deception extends clear and distinct certainty beyond the cogito, yet that hinge creates the Cartesian Circle.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Cartesian dualism gains conceptual clarity by separating thought from extension, but its success in distinction becomes its central causal problem because heterogeneous substances must still explain one life.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza radicalises the Cartesian definition of substance until only God or Nature remains self-conceived, making minds and bodies dependent modes rather than independently interacting things.

SPINOZA'S PARALLELISM AND ROUTE FROM BONDAGE TO FREEDOM

ONE EVENT

UNDER THOUGHT

UNDER EXTENSION

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS

NO CROSS-ATTRIBUTE CAUSAL TRANSFER; PARALLELISM REPLACES CARTESIAN INTERACTION

FINITE MODES ARE NECESSARILY CAUSED; CONTINGENCY RECORDS IGNORANCE OF

ONE EVENT → under THOUGHT: idea → under EXTENSION: body-state

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS

NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction

FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

ONE EVENT → under THOUGHT: idea → under EXTENSION: body-state

ORDER AND CONNECTION OF IDEAS = ORDER AND CONNECTION OF THINGS

NO cross-attribute causal transfer; parallelism replaces Cartesian interaction

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

FINITE MODES are necessarily caused; contingency records ignorance of causes

CONATUS = each thing's striving to persevere in being

INADEQUATE IDEAS + external causes → passive affects → BONDAGE

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

COMMON NOTIONS / REASON / INTUITION → ADEQUATE IDEAS → ACTIVITY

FREEDOM = acting from understood nature within necessity, not uncaused choice

LIMIT: autonomy survives, but alternative possibilities do not.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

The same modal event is expressed under Thought as an idea and under Extension as a body-state, eliminating cross-attribute causal transfer.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Spinoza reconciles freedom with determinism by treating freedom not as uncaused choice but as adequate self-determination within the necessary order of God or Nature.

06

STAGE 06

LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY

LEIBNIZ'S MONAD HIERARCHY, PERCEPTION AND INDIVIDUALITY

WHY MONADS? EXTENSION IS DIVISIBLE; ULTIMATE SUBSTANCE MUST BE

NECESSARY SUPREME MONAD

COMPLETE INTELLIGENCE

RATIONAL SPIRITS

APPERCEPTION + REASON + MORAL AGENCY

ANIMAL SOULS

MEMORY + CLEARER PERCEPTION

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence

RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

WHY MONADS? extension is divisible; ultimate substance must be simple

GOD: necessary supreme monad / complete intelligence

RATIONAL SPIRITS: apperception + reason + moral agency

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

ANIMAL SOULS: memory + clearer perception

BARE MONADS: obscure petites perceptions

EVERY MONAD: simple, unextended, windowless, perceptive and appetitive

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

APPETITION = internal transition; each perspective expresses the universe

IDENTITY OF INDISCERNIBLES secures uniqueness

BODIES = well-founded phenomena, not ultimate substances.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

Appetition moves each monad from one perception to another according to its own law, while its perspective differentiates it from every other monad.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Leibniz makes substance simple and active: each monad is a unique perspectival centre whose internally unfolding perceptions preserve individuality without material parts or causal influx.

07

STAGE 07

LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM

LEIBNIZIAN HARMONY, SUFFICIENT REASON, CONTINGENCY AND FREEDOM

GOD CHOOSES A COMPOSSIBLE BEST WORLD UNDER THE PRINCIPLE

MIND-MONAD STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY

BODILY/ORGANIC STATES UNFOLD INTERNALLY

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY MAKES THEM CORRESPOND WITHOUT INTERACTION

TRUTHS OF REASON

OPPOSITE CONTRADICTORY

LOGICALLY NECESSARY

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON

mind-monad states unfold internally

bodily/organic states unfold internally

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

SOURCE / DOCTRINE

GOD chooses a compossible best world under the PRINCIPLE OF SUFFICIENT REASON

mind-monad states unfold internally

bodily/organic states unfold internally

PRE-ESTABLISHED HARMONY makes them correspond without interaction

ARGUMENT / MECHANISM

TRUTHS OF REASON: opposite contradictory → logically necessary

TRUTHS OF FACT: opposite conceivable → contingent though certain

COMPLETE CONCEPT: all predicates belong to the individual known fully by God

FREEDOM: spontaneity + intelligence + contingency; reasons incline, not coerce

IMPLICATION / VERDICT

OBJECTION: programming/evil; REPLY: self-expression + optimal compossibility

LIMIT: compatibility is stronger than libertarian freedom.

MECHANISM / VERDICT —

God chooses a compossible world and creates monads whose internally lawful sequences correspond without causal exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM:

Leibniz preserves freedom by distinguishing certainty from absolute necessity: rational actions arise spontaneously from the agent's own reasons, which incline without necessitating in the logical sense.

08

STAGE 08

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

LEIBNIZ SUBSTANCE

GOD + MIND + BODY

ONE GOD OR NATURE

MANY SIMPLE MONADS

IMMANENT REALITY

SELECTOR/COORDINATOR MIND-BODY

HARMONY ORDER

MECHANISM / VERDICT — God chooses a compossible world and creates monads whose internally lawful sequences correspond without causal exchange.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Leibniz preserves freedom by distinguishing certainty from absolute necessity: rational actions arise spontaneously from the agent's own reasons, which incline without necessitating in the logical sense.

08

STAGE 08 THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

THREE RATIONALIST SYSTEMS COMPARED ON MATCHED AXES

LEIBNIZ SUBSTANCE

GOD + MIND + BODY

ONE GOD OR NATURE

MANY SIMPLE MONADS

IMMANENT REALITY

SELECTOR/COORDINATOR MIND-BODY

HARMONY ORDER

SYSTEM / DOCTRINE	DECISIVE DISTINCTION	EVALUATION / TRAP
LEIBNIZ substance	selector/coordinator mind-body	rational assent
God + mind + body	harmony order	adequate activity
one God or Nature	mechanism + will	intelligent spontaneity
many simple monads	strict necessity	PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.
SYSTEM / DOCTRINE • LEIBNIZ substance • God + mind + body • one God or Nature • many simple monads • immanent reality	DECISIVE DISTINCTION • selector/coordinator mind-body • harmony order • mechanism + will • strict necessity • certain/contingent freedom	EVALUATION / TRAP • rational assent • adequate activity • intelligent spontaneity • PRESSURE SEQUENCE: interaction gap → monist unity → restored individuality.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Each successor accepts the Cartesian pressure but redistributes substance and causation to avoid direct interaction between heterogeneous realities.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Spinoza removes the interaction gap by collapsing Cartesian substances into attributes of one order, while Leibniz restores plurality by replacing interaction with divinely coordinated internal activity.

09

STAGE 09 CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

CRITICISM-REPLY LEDGER, TRAPS, PYQ ROUTES AND ANSWER SPINE

INTERACTION GAP

PRIMITIVE UNION

MECHANISM REMAINS OPAQUE

ADEQUATE ACTIVITY + MODAL REALITY

NO ALTERNATIVES

SPONTANEITY + POSSIBLE WORLDS

RESIDUAL PRESSURE



DOCTRINE / CLAIM	OBJECTION / PRESSURE	REPLY / RESIDUAL
• DESCARTES: interaction gap → primitive union → mechanism remains opaque • SPINOZA: necessity/acosmism → adequate activity + modal reality → no alternatives • LEIBNIZ: programming/evil/economy → spontaneity + possible worlds → residual pressure • PRECISION: substance != attribute != mode; mind != person; necessity != fatalism	• PRECISION: spontaneity != autonomy; compatibilism != libertarian freedom • PYQ ROUTES: certainty/self-world; substance 3-1-infinity; pantheism; freedom • PYQ ROUTES: innate ideas; monads/harmony; God; determination/negation • ANSWER SPINE	• directive → thesis → definitions → argument → example → objection → reply → verdict • CONTROL: claim → named evidence → analysis → qualification • VERDICT: intelligibility is gained at recurring costs to interaction and autonomy.

MECHANISM / VERDICT — Precision turns system summaries into answers by linking every doctrine to a named inferential role and an explicit qualification.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A criticism-reply answer spine reveals rationalism's central tension: systematic intelligibility repeatedly pressures interaction, contingency and autonomous individuality.

E

EXTRA SUBORDINATE ENRICHMENT — ONLY AFTER THE COMPLETE CORE

OPTIONAL ADVANCED ENRICHMENT

ADVANCED SESSION 1 — RATIONALISM MASTER MAP AND BASIC

ADVANCED SESSION 2 — CARTESIAN DOUBT, COGITO AND CERTAIN

ADVANCED SESSION 3 — WAX, EXTERNAL WORLD, DIVINE GUARANTEE

ADVANCED SESSION 4 — SUBSTANCE

ONE INHERITED CRITERION, DESCARTES 3, SPINOZA 1, LEIBNIZ INFINITY

ADVANCED SESSION 5 — GOD

CARTESIAN GUARANTEE, SPINOZIST IMMANENT NATURE, LEIBNIZIAN SELECTOR

OPTIONAL SOURCE WITNESS	ADVANCED OBJECTION	COMPARATIVE NUANCE
• ADVANCED SESSION 1 — Rationalism Master Map and Basic Tenets • ADVANCED SESSION 2 — Cartesian Doubt, Cogito and Certain Self-Knowledge • ADVANCED SESSION 3 — Wax, External World, Divine Guarantee and the Cartesian Circle • ADVANCED SESSION 4 — Substance: One Inherited Criterion, Descartes 3, Spinoza 1, Leibniz Infinity	• ADVANCED SESSION 5 — God: Cartesian Guarantee, Spinozist Immanent Nature, Leibnizian Selector • ADVANCED SESSION 6 — Mind and Body: Interactionism, Parallelism and Pre-Established Harmony • ADVANCED SESSION 7 — Freedom and Determinism Across the Rationalist Trio • ADVANCED SESSION 8 — Spinoza's Integrated System: Necessity, Knowledge, Pantheism and Negation	• ADVANCED SESSION 9 — Leibniz: Monads, Sufficient Reason, Contingency and Harmony • ADVANCED SESSION 10 — Criticisms, Comparisons, PYQ Routing and Provenance-Safe Answer Architecture • ADVANCED DOSSIER REFINEMENTS — USE SELECTIVELY • Core prerequisite : finish the owner first for Cartesian Method and Certain Knowledge

OPTIONAL STATUS — This optional depth is unnecessary for a competent core answer; use it only for added nuance after the complete core has been written.